

How Winter Began

The world had just begun; it was dark and always summer. Animals lived comfortably – all except Coyote, who being a poor hunter, never had enough food. One day, he spotted Eagle hunting rabbits **skillfully** and teamed up with him, hoping to catch some **prey**. However, by day's end, Eagle had caught several rabbits and Coyote, a few measly bugs. **Embarrassed**, Coyote said, "No **wonder** I can't catch anything — it's so dark! Do you know where we can get some light?"

"Come with me," said Eagle and they made their way to a clearing where the Kachinas, a powerful people, were performing a **ceremonial** dance. Eagle **pointed to** them and said, "They have light hidden in two boxes. The bigger box contains a huge ball of fire called Sun, which they use when they need more light. The smaller box contains a **pale** ball called Moon which gives less light."

The **duo** waited in the **bushes** and when the Kachinas had slept, Eagle picked up the larger box and **flew off**, Coyote following closely on foot.

Sometime later, Coyote **yelled out**, "You will get tired **ferrying** that big box for so long. Let me carry it **for a while**."

Eagle handed him the box saying, "Take good care of it. And don't try anything funny."

The load slowed Coyote down and once out of Eagle's sight, he decided to take a small **peek** into the box. So, he opened it, unaware that to make carrying easy, Eagle had put Sun and Moon in the same box. As soon as the **lid** fell open, Sun and Moon escaped into the sky. Eagle saw what Coyote had done and tried to catch the **runaway orbs** but it was too late. Sun moved far away from the



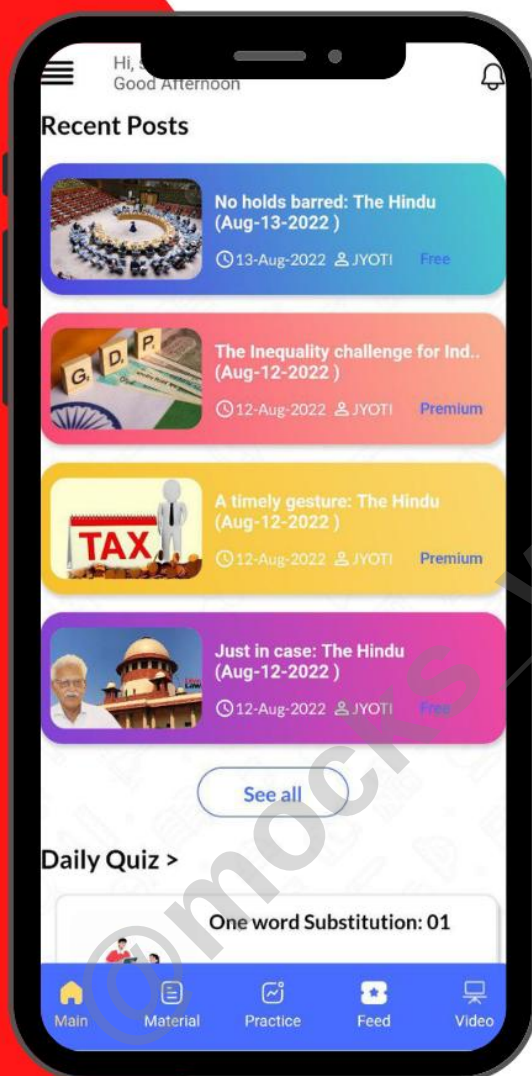
Earth while Moon **settled** itself much closer, changing the warm summer into winter. Plants **shrivelled up** with cold and it began to snow, causing all animals to take shelter.

"Look what you've done, fool!" **exclaimed** Eagle to the **shivering** Coyote. "You've let Sun and Moon escape and now it has brought the cold upon us." And since then, winter comes every year.

Vocabulary

1. **Skillfully** (adverb) – expertly, cleverly, proficiently, adroitly कुशलता से
2. **Prey** (noun) – victim, quarry, hunted animal, target शिकार
3. **Embarrassed** (adjective) – ashamed, awkward, uneasy, self-conscious शर्मिदा / लज्जित
4. **Wonder** (noun) – curiosity, amazement, surprise, awe आश्चर्य / जिज्ञासा
5. **Ceremonial** (adjective) – ritualistic, formal, traditional, solemn औपचारिक / रस्मों से जुड़ा
6. **Point to** (phrasal verb) – indicate, show, signal, direct attention संकेत करना
7. **Pale** (adjective) – light-colored, faint, dim, washed-out पीला / फीका
8. **Duo** (noun) – pair, couple, two people together, twosome जोड़ी / दो साथी
9. **Bush** (noun) – shrub, plant, thicket, undergrowth झाड़ी / छोटा पौधा
10. **Flew off** (phrasal verb) – took flight, departed flying, soared away उड़ गया / उड़ते हुए चला गया
11. **Yell out** (phrasal verb) – shout loudly, cry out, call out, exclaim चिल्लाना / जोर से बोलना
12. **Ferrying** (noun) – carrying, transporting, moving, hauling ढोना / ले जाना
13. **For a while** (phrase) – temporarily, for some time, briefly थोड़ी देर तक
14. **Peek** (noun) – glance, quick look, glimpse, sneak view झलक / झांकना
15. **Lid** (noun) – cover, top, cap, seal ढक्कन / ढकने वाला भाग
16. **Runaway** (adjective) – uncontrolled, escaped, out of control, unrestrained नियंत्रण से बाहर / भागा हुआ
17. **Orbs** (noun) – spheres, globes, celestial bodies गोल आकृतियाँ / गोल पिंड (जैसे सूरज-चंद्र)
18. **Settle** (verb) – position, rest, come to rest, land ठहर जाना / स्थित होना
19. **Shrivel up** (phrasal verb) – dry up, wilt, wither, shrink सिकुड़ना / मुरझाना
20. **Exclaim** (verb) – shout, cry out, call out, yell चिल्लाना / जोर से कहना
21. **Shivering** (noun) – trembling, shaking, quivering, quaking (from cold or fear) कंपन / ठिठुरन

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